SEO Changelog: Blog (Crab Island and Destin Travel Guide)

URL: https://crabislandtikitoursdestin.com/crab-island-destin-travel-guide/ | WP page ID 726 (Elementor) | Last modified July 15, 2026 | Audit date: October 29, 2026 | Page 20 of the site queue

Method: page content, SEO meta and the post list were pulled from WordPress through the site connector. The post grid is likely an Elementor Posts or Loop widget, which the connector doesn't show, so its layout and settings should be checked in the editor.

1. Summary

Item	Current state
Role	Index of blog posts. Should help visitors find articles and pass link value to them.
SEO title	Crab Island & Destin Travel Guide (33 characters, room to add more)
Meta description	132 characters including a trailing space
H1	Crab Island and Destin Travel Guide (good)
Text	One sentence and a booking button. The post grid adds titles and excerpts.
Posts	7 published, all in "Uncategorized". Two (773 and 910) are set to be merged and redirected, leaving 5.
Overlap	"Crab Island and Destin Travel Guide" sounds like the same thing as the About Crab Island hub, which is the stronger guide. Visitors and Google get two "guide" hubs.

2. Critical fixes

#	Issue	Fix
1	P1 Two hubs competing	Give each a clear job. About Crab Island: the eight evergreen Crab Island answers. Blog: seasonal tips, Destin activities, news and trip stories. Rename the blog H1 and title to match (section 3), and add a "Start here: Crab Island guide" block at the top linking to the hub.
2	P1 All posts "Uncategorized"	Create 3 or 4 categories and assign every post (section 5). Rename the default "Uncategorized" so it can't show on new posts.
3	P2 Posts about to be redirected	After posts 773 and 910 are merged into their guide pages, make sure the grid doesn't show cached copies and that no blog post still links to them.
4	P2 Posts page setting	Check Settings > Reading. If this page isn't set as the Posts page, WordPress may also generate a separate default blog archive. Pick one so there's only one blog index.

3. SEO title, meta and H1

Field	Current	New
SEO title	Crab Island & Destin Travel Guide	**Destin Travel Blog: Crab Island Tips, Seasons and Things to Do** (62 characters)
Meta description	Discover local tips, travel guides, family advice, and everything you need to know before visiting Crab Island and Destin, Florida.	**Local tips from Destin charter captains: when to visit Crab Island, tides, family advice, storm updates and things to do in Destin beyond the sandbar.** (150 characters)
H1	Crab Island and Destin Travel Guide	**Destin and Crab Island Travel Blog**
URL	/crab-island-destin-travel-guide/ is fine. Changing it isn't worth the redirect.	

4. Heading structure

Current

```
H1  Crab Island and Destin Travel Guide
    (one sentence, booking button, post grid)
```

New

```
H1  Destin and Crab Island Travel Blog
    (2-sentence intro)
H2  New to Crab Island? Start Here         (links to hub + 3 top guides)
H2  Latest Posts                            (post grid)
H2  Browse by Topic                         (category links)
H2  Book a Private Tiki Boat Trip
```

Post titles in the grid should render as H3 (or H2 inside the "Latest Posts" section). Check the Posts widget's title HTML tag setting.

5. Content rewrites (paste-ready)

Intro under H1

> Tips from the captains at Crab Island Tiki Tours: when to go, what the tides are doing, how to plan around storms and what else to do in Destin. For quick answers about Crab Island itself, start with our Crab Island guide.

H2: New to Crab Island? Start Here

> - What is Crab Island?
> - How do you get to Crab Island?
> - How much does it cost to go to Crab Island?

> - Best time to go to Crab Island

Categories to create

Category	Posts
Crab Island Tips	High Tide vs Low Tide (924), Is Crab Island Family Friendly? (585)
Seasons and Weather	Why Fall Is a Great Time (1019), Hurricane Isaias update (1074)
Things to Do in Destin	Things to Do in Destin Besides Crab Island (1066)
Celebrations (future)	Bachelorette ideas, birthdays, proposals

Rank Math can noindex thin category archives with only one or two posts until they fill up (Titles & Meta > Categories).

Post ideas that fill gaps (not covered by any page yet)

- Destin fireworks schedule (links to public fireworks tours)
- Crab Island bachelorette party ideas and checklist
- Dolphin watching in Destin: what to expect
- Crab Island rules and etiquette (expands the What Is section)
- Where to eat by boat in Destin (supports the restaurant-stop selling point)

H2: Book a Private Tiki Boat Trip (replaces the bare button)

> Up to 18 guests, a USCG-licensed captain and a bathroom onboard. See private Crab Island charters or the private sunset cruise. *Button: Check Availability*

6. Internal linking

Anchor text	Target	Placement
Crab Island guide	/about-crab-island/	Intro
4 guide titles	/about-crab-island/ child pages	Start Here
private Crab Island charters	/charters/private-crab-island-charter-destin/	Book section
private sunset cruise	/charters/private-sunset-cruise-in-destin-fl/	Book section
Category names	/category/... archives	Browse by Topic

Inbound: the main menu "Blog" item should point here. Add "Travel Blog" to the footer too.

7. Images

- Every post needs a featured image for the grid. Post 910's is a .heic file (that post is being redirected); check the others display.
- Set a featured image on this page for social shares.

8. Technical

#	Item	Action
1	P2 Schema	CollectionPage (Rank Math) for this page; each post as Article/BlogPosting with author.
2	P2 Pagination	When the blog passes 9 to 12 posts, use real paginated URLs (/page/2/), not "Load more" buttons that crawlers can't follow.
3	P3 Post URLs	Posts live at the root (/high-tide-vs-low-tide-at-crab-island/). That's fine; don't change permalinks now.

9. Tracking

Event	Setup
post_click	Clicks from the grid to a post, with `post_title`.
Content group	In GA4 (via GTM or Site Kit), set `content_group` to "blog", "guide", "product" and "company" by URL pattern. Then you can compare how each type of page leads to bookings.
book_now_click	`button_location=blog_index`.

10. Changelog

#	Area	Change	Priority	Status
1	Content	Separate blog from the Crab Island hub; "Start Here" block linking to the hub	P1	To do
2	Technical	Create categories; reassign all posts; rename Uncategorized	P1	To do
3	Meta	New title (62 characters) and description (150 characters)	P2	To do
4	Headings	New H1; Start Here, Latest Posts, Browse by Topic, Book H2s	P2	To do
5	Technical	Check Settings > Reading posts page; grid title tags; pagination	P2	To do
6	Content	Plan 5 new posts to fill content gaps	P2	To do
7	Images	Featured images on every post and this page	P2	To do
8	Tracking	post_click; GA4 content groups	P3	To do